

SPACEFROGS™

MISSION 0 - FIRST CONTACT

Printable Master Playtest Pack v1.0

A compact first-play packet for testing the core SPACEFROGS tactical loop: movement, relay objective, Watcher Drone AI, Alert pressure and extraction tension.

MODE	Co-op PvE
PLAYERS	1-4
TIME	20-35 minutes
MISSION	Quickstart Mission 0 - First Contact
STATUS	Playtest draft - not final balance

WAKE THE FROG. BREAK THE MACHINE.

1. Mission Brief

A small SpaceFrogs fireteam reaches the swamp edge where a corrupted signal relay is pulsing under the mud. MachineUnits09 have already detected movement. The Frogs must reach the relay, decode it, survive the first machine response and extract before the battlefield locks down.

What this mission tests

- Do players understand movement, range and line of sight quickly?
- Does the relay objective create pressure?
- Do Watcher Drones feel readable but dangerous?
- Does the mission end with a cinematic moment?
- Does the game feel like SPACEFROGS, not generic sci-fi?

Components needed

- Frog units: Leader, Ranger, Tech Specialist.
- Enemy units: 3 Watcher Drones. Optional: 1 Pursuit Hound at Alert 5.
- Board: 12x12 starter grid or equivalent small modular battlefield.
- Tokens: Relay Objective, 3 Decode Progress, Extraction marker, Noise / Alert tokens.

Victory and defeat

- Frog victory: Relay reaches 3 Decode Progress and at least 2 Frog units extract safely.
- Machine victory: 2+ Frog units are downed, Alert reaches 6 before the relay is decoded, or Frogs fail extraction.

2. Basic Mission Rules

- Each Frog gets 2 actions per turn: Move, Shoot, Decode Relay, Interact, Take Cover, Revive, Dash.
- Decode Relay: Tech adds 1 Decode Progress without Noise. Other Frogs add 1 Decode Progress and 1 Noise.
- Relay is decoded at 3 Decode Progress.
- Noise attracts MachineUnits09.
- Alert starts at 0. At Alert 3, Drones become aggressive. At Alert 5, optional Pursuit Hound enters. At Alert 6, lockdown begins.

3. Quick Unit Cards

UNIT	MOVE	HP	DEF	ATTACK	ROLE / ABILITY
Leader	5	8	4+	2 dice	Command Pulse: once per round, one Frog within 4 zones rerolls 1 failed die. Hold the
Ranger	7	6	5+	2 dice / 3 close	Leap Dash: +2 movement once per round, add 1 Noise. Close Strike: +1 die at close r
Tech Specialist	5	6	5+	1 die	Clean Decode: add 1 Decode Progress without Noise. Signal Patch: remove 1 Noise w
Watcher Drone	5	3	5+	1 die	AI: shoot visible Frog, else move to Noise, else move to Relay, scan Relay for +1 Alert
Pursuit Hound	8	5	4+	3 dice	Optional at Alert 5. Predator Leap ignores one terrain penalty. Reduce to 2 dice if too s

Watcher Drone AI priority

- 1. If a Frog is visible and in range: shoot.
- 2. If a Noise token exists: move toward nearest Noise token.
- 3. If no Noise token exists: move toward the Relay Objective.
- 4. If adjacent to Relay: scan it and add +1 Alert.
- At Alert 3+, Watcher Drones shoot before moving if they can see a Frog.

4. Board Layout - 12x12 Starter Grid

Columns A-L. Rows 1-12. Frogs start near Row 1. MachineUnits09 start near Row 10-12. Relay Objective sits near the center.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
12	.	.	.	M	.	.	.	.	M	.	.	.
11	.	C	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	C	.	.
10	.	.	.	.	M	.	.	M	.	.	.	.
09	.	.	C	.	.	.	.	.	.	C	.	.
08	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.
07	.	.	.	C	.	R	R	.	C	.	.	.
06	.	.	.	C	.	R	R	.	C	.	.	.
05	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.
04	.	C	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	C	.
03	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.
02	.	.	F	F	.	.	.	.	F	F	.	.
01	.	.	F	F	.	.	.	.	F	F	.	.

- F = Frog Deployment, M = Watcher Drone Start, R = Relay Objective, C = Cover, . = Open terrain.
- Relay Objective: F6, G6, F7, G7.
- Recommended Frog start: Leader D2, Ranger C1 or I1, Tech Specialist J2 or D1.
- Watcher Drones: D12, E10, H10 or I12.
- Extraction: return to Frog deployment edge after Relay is decoded.

Difficulty tuning

- Easy: 2 Watcher Drones, no Pursuit Hound.
- Standard: 3 Watcher Drones, Hound enters at Alert 5.
- Hard: Hound enters at Alert 4, Drones aggressive at Alert 2, Relay needs 4 progress.

5. Mission Loop

PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT WE TEST
01 Deploy	Frogs enter from swamp edge. Place relay objective near center.	Setup clarity and first-turn confidence.
02 Contact	Frogs advance. Watcher Drones patrol toward signal/noise.	Tactical space and first enemy read.
03 Decode	Frogs begin relay decode. Noise and Alert rise.	Objective pressure and team roles.
04 Escalate	Alert reaches 3 or relay reaches 2 progress. Drones become more directive.	Threat and pacing.
05 Extract	Relay decoded. Frogs must leave through extraction edge.	Endgame tension and cinematic finish.

6. Playtest Questions

- What was the clearest part of the mission?
- What was confusing?
- Did the Watcher Drones feel dangerous?
- Did the Relay objective feel meaningful?
- Was the mission too slow, too fast or just right?
- Did the Frogs feel heroic?
- Did MachineUnits09 feel like a real threat?
- What moment felt most cinematic?
- What should be removed?
- What should be added next?

7. Feedback Form Copy

- Name / Callsign
- Email
- How many players tested? Solo / 2 / 3 / 4
- Did you finish? Frog victory / Machine victory / Stopped / Rules unclear
- How long did it take? Under 20 / 20-35 / 35-50 / Over 50 minutes
- Rules clarity 1-5, pacing 1-5, Machine threat 1-5, Frog identity 1-5
- Most cinematic moment, most confusing moment, what should be removed, what should be added next
- Consent checkbox: I agree that SPACEFROGS may store my feedback and contact me about future playtests and launch updates.

8. Email to Playtesters

Subject: SPACEFROGS(TM) Mission 0 - First Contact Playtest

Welcome to the first SPACEFROGS(TM) field test.

Your mission:

Reach the corrupted relay.

Decode the signal.

Survive MachineUnits09.

Extract before the battlefield locks down.

What we need from you:

- Was the mission clear?
- Did the pacing feel good?
- Did the Watcher Drones feel dangerous?
- Did the Frogs feel heroic?
- What moment felt most cinematic?

This is an early playtest draft, not final rules or final art.

The goal is to find the true signal before we polish the Core Box.

Wake the Frog. Break the Machine.

- SPACEFROGS(TM) HQ

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